

Choosing Representatives

PS102

We have considered:

- Democracy and autocracy
- The economic origins of democracy
- The institutions of autocracy

Scientifically we are working on:

- Defining concepts
- Measuring those concepts
- Strengths/weaknesses of measures

→ Describing & theorizing patterns

Next three lectures:

*Why are some democracies more
"representative" than others?*

- Today: Electoral rules
- Wednesday: Legislative process
- Next Wednesday: Holding politicians accountable

Consider January of 2016

Republicans controlled the White House & Congress...



Trump



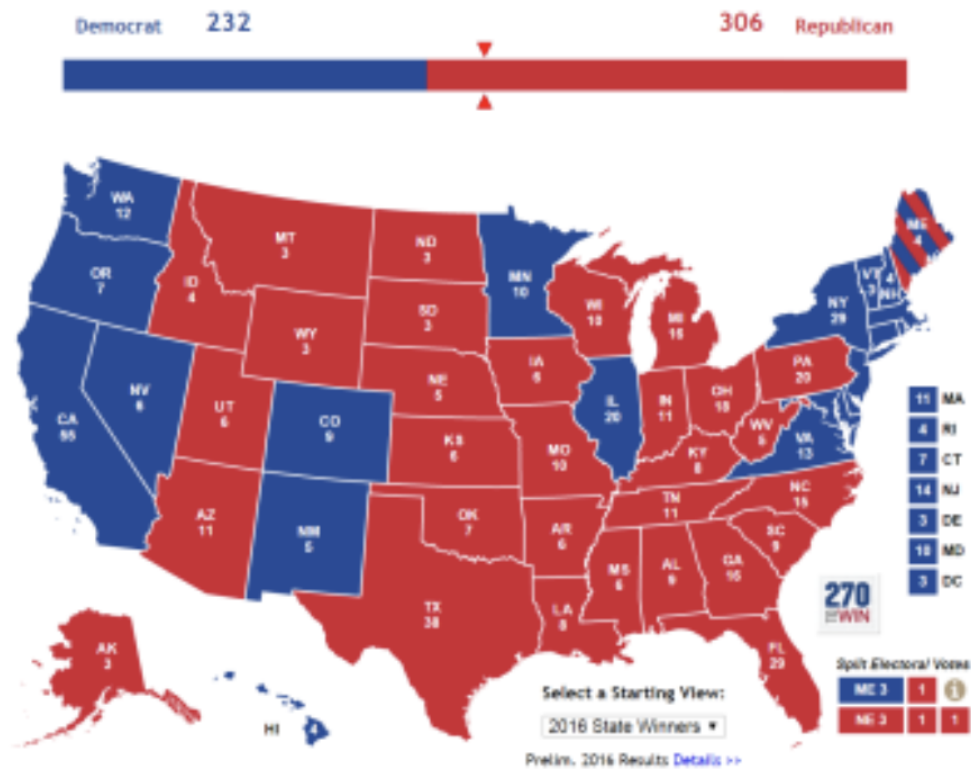
Ryan
(House)

McConnell
(Senate)

...even though Clinton won popular vote.

Clinton: 65.8 M votes (48.2%)

Trump: 63.0 M votes (46.1%)



Republicans had disproportionate share of House seats

	Percentage of popular vote	Percentage of seats in House
Republicans	49.1	55.4
Democrats	48.0	44.6
Others	2.9	0.0

(Composition as of January 2017)

More extreme disproportionality than 2012/3

Republicans won the House, despite losing the popular vote!

	Percentage of popular vote	Percentage of seats in House
Republicans	46.9	53.8
Democrats	48.3	46.2
Others	4.8	0.0

(Composition as of January 2013)

Republicans controlled the Senate, despite getting fewer votes

	Percentage of popular vote	Percentage of seats in Senate
Republicans	44.2	52
Democrats	51.6	46
Others	4.2	2

Notes: Popular vote = sum of votes in 2012, 2014, 2016.
Two independents (Angus King of Maine and Bernie Sanders of Vermont) caucus with Democrats.

What is disproportionality?

The difference between

vote share and **seat share**

- How do votes get translated into seats?

→ The electoral system

- Are some electoral systems “better” than others?

U.S. has 2 major parties



Other parties get little traction, e.g. Libertarian, Green, Constitution

American Freedom Party, American Solidarity Party, America's Party, Black Riders Liberation Party, Christian Liberty Party, Citizens Party of the United States, Communist Party USA, Freedom Socialist Party, Humane Party, Independent American Party, Justice Party, Legal Marijuana Now Party, Modern Whig Party, National Socialist Movement, New Black Panther Party, Objectivist Party, Party for Socialism and Liberation, Peace and Freedom Party, Prohibition Party, Reform Party of the United States of America, Socialist Action, Socialist Alternative, Socialist Equality Party, Socialist Party USA, Socialist Labor Party of America, Socialist Workers Party, United States Marijuana Party, United States Pacifist Party, United States Pirate Party, Unity Party of America, Veterans Party of America, Workers World Party , and others

Jamaica also has 2 major parties



Vote: 50.1%
Seats: 50.8%



Vote: 49.7%
Seats: 49.2%

Nearly 50 other parties have tried without success.

Seat shares from 2016-17 for comparison to US.

By contrast—Israel has 10 major parties

	Percentage of popular vote	Percentage of seats in Knesset
Likud	23.4	25.0
Zionist Union	18.7	20.0
Joint List	10.6	10.8
Yesh Atid	8.8	9.2
Kulanu	7.5	8.3
The Jewish Home	6.7	6.7
Shas	5.7	5.8
Yisrael Beiteinu	5.1	5.0
United Torah Judaism	5.0	5.0
Meretz	3.9	4.2
Others	4.5	0

Many of these parties have factions!

Seat shares from 2016-17 for comparison to US.

Other multiparty democracies

India	36 parties
Brazil	19 parties
Netherlands	11 parties
Indonesia	10 parties

- What explains why some democracies have many parties and others only two?

→ Electoral systems matter

Today we'll consider

- Rules for electing a president
- Rules for electing a legislature

**** EXERCISE ****

What happens if there's no majority?

12th Amendment: If no candidate gets a majority in the Electoral College, the House of Representatives shall choose the President (from among the top 3).

The House decided the 1824 election



Andrew
Jackson

John Q.
Adams

Henry
Clay

William
Crawford

Popular Vote:

41.4%

30.9%

13.0%

11.2%

Electoral College:

99

84

37

41

House of Reps:

7

13

Not allowed

4

Rules for electing the President

Plurality-Majority (First Past the Post)

Candidate with the most votes wins, even if <50%.

- Kenya, Zambia, Philippines, S. Korea, Taiwan, Iceland, Mexico, Nicaragua, Paraguay

Two-Stage

*First stage: Candidate with >50% wins, if no candidate wins first round, top two candidates move on to... Second stage: >50% wins.**

- Ghana, Indonesia, Mongolia, Czech Rep., France, Poland, Portugal, Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Peru

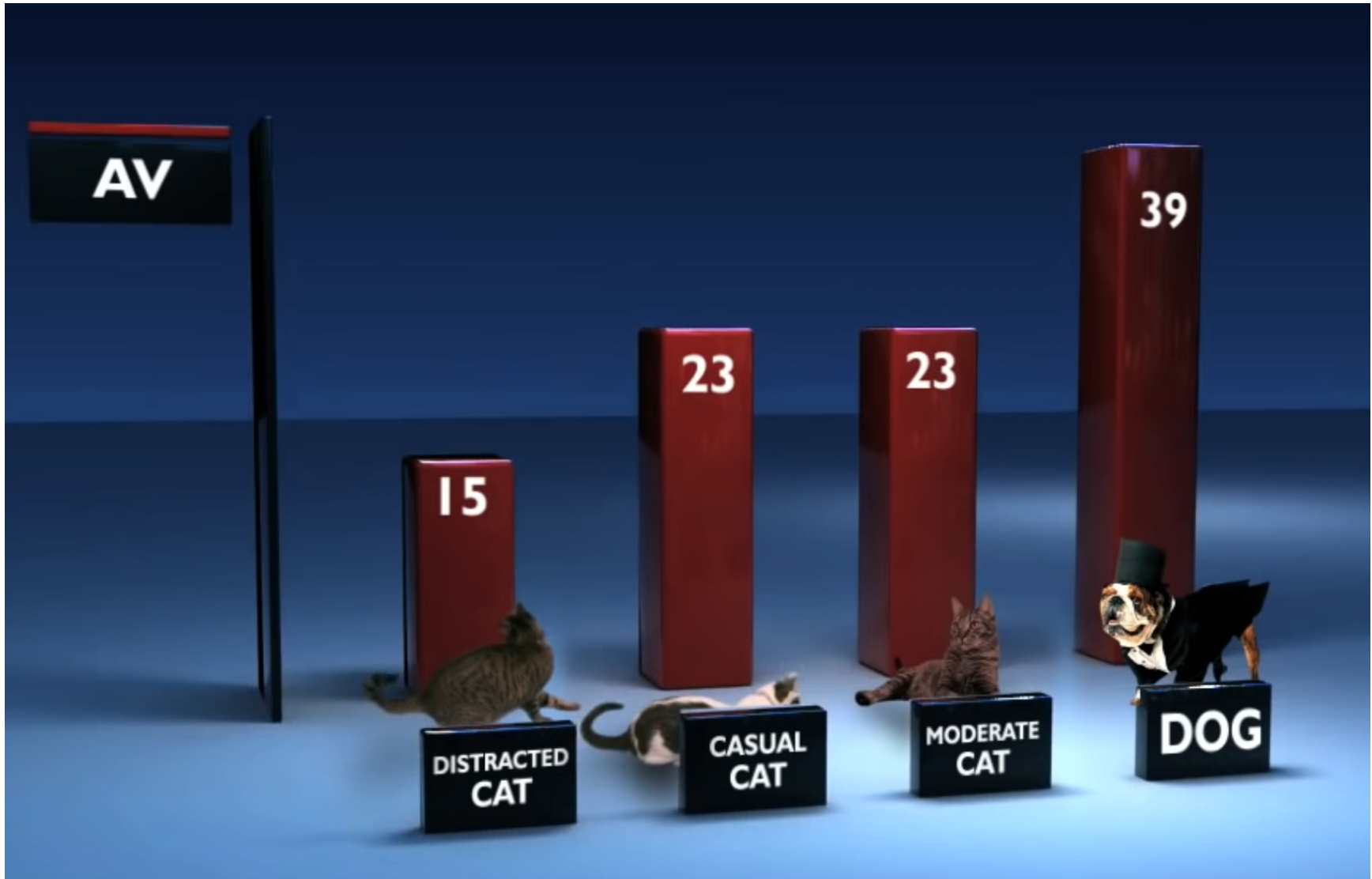
* First stage percentage may not be 50%. Sometimes more than the top 2 candidates move on (any that don't meet a particular minimum vote). Sometimes second stage is only plurality, not majority required.

Alternative Vote

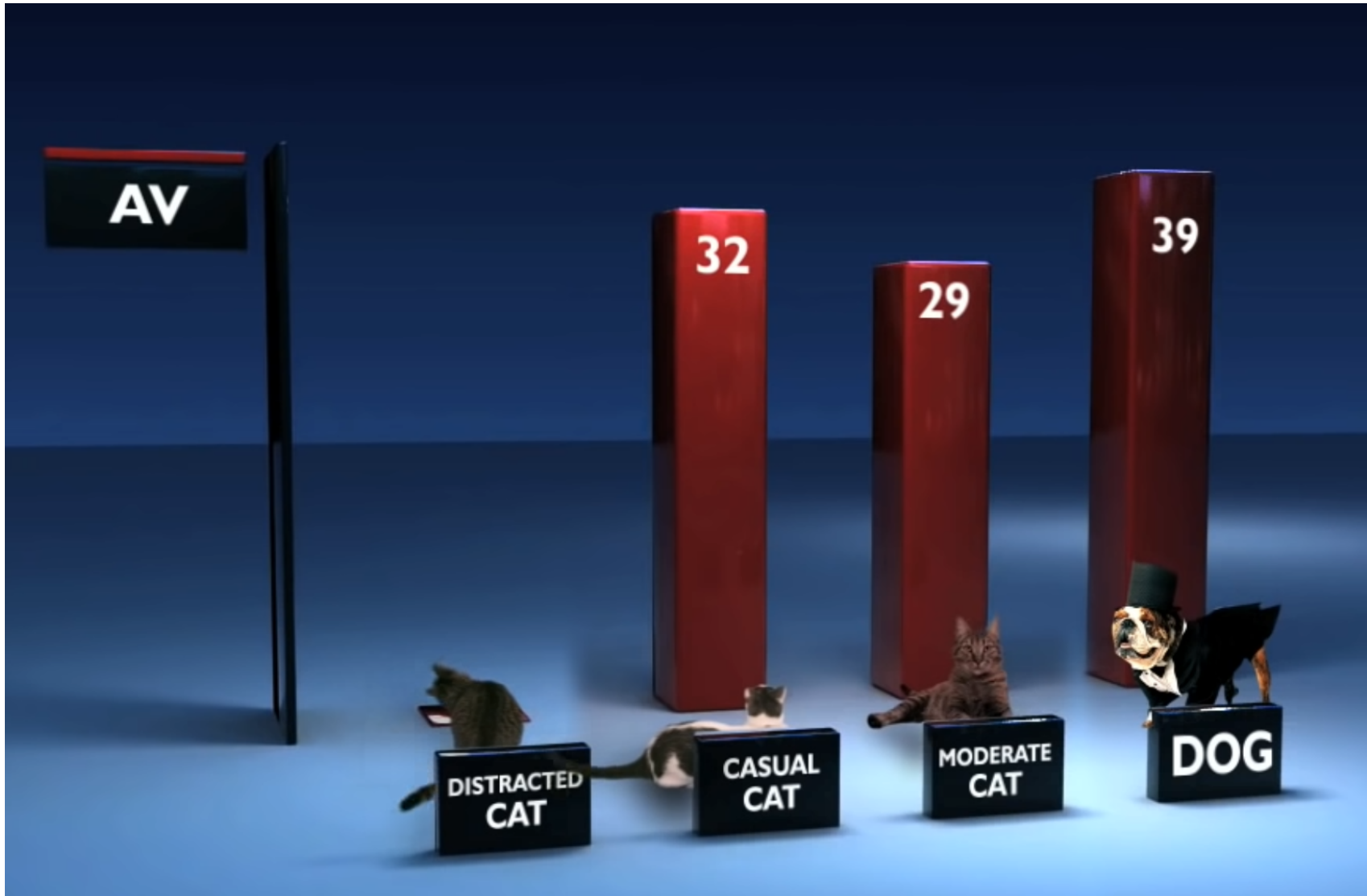
Rank order of all candidates, count of first place votes, majority first place votes win; or lowest first place votes removed, redistributed until there is a majority

- Australia, Ireland

Alternative Vote



Alternative vote



AV

50%

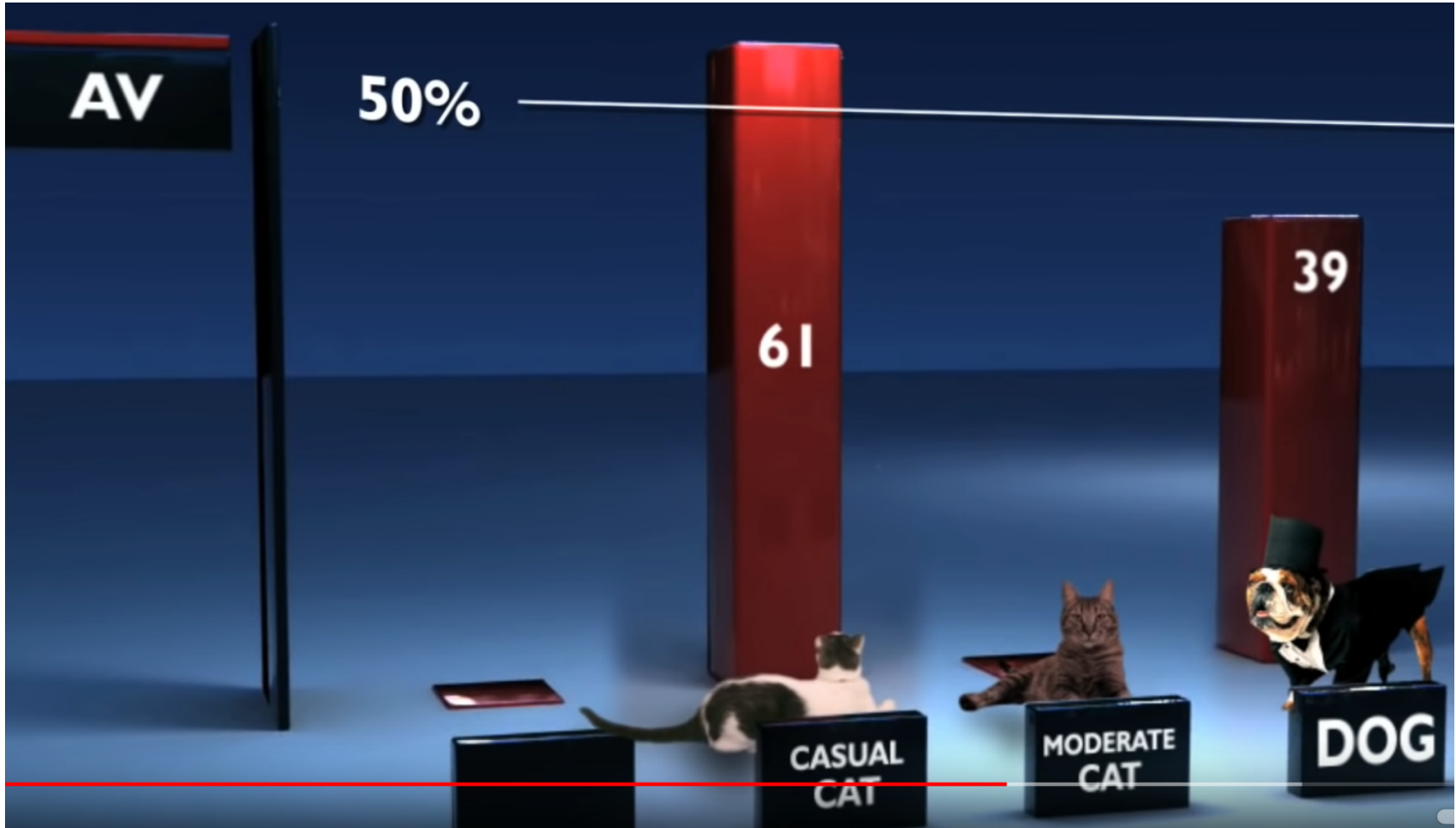
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39

CASUAL CAT

MODERATE CAT

DOG



Legislative electoral systems

Two main features:

- District magnitude: The number of seats per district
- Electoral formula: The formula for translating votes into seats

District magnitude

- 1 seat per district (single member district, SMD)

Examples: U.S., U.K., India

- >1 seat per district (multi member district, MMD)

Examples: France, Germany, Mauritius, Denmark, Sweden

- All seats in one district

Examples: Israel, Netherlands

Electoral formula

- Plurality (Plurality-Majority)
- Proportional Representation (PR)

Specific PR systems

- List PR
- Mixed Member Proportional (MMP)
- Single Transferable Vote (STV)

Combinations of formula and magnitude

Formula	District Magnitude		
	One	Many	All
Plurality	UK, USA, India	Some US States	---
PR	---	Denmark, Sweden	Israel, Netherlands

Note the correlation between formula and magnitude.

3 hypotheses about the effects of formula and magnitude

1. Plurality → disproportionality
2. Within PR systems, low district magnitude → disproportionality
3. Within plurality systems, high district magnitude → disproportionality.

Why? What is the logic of these hypotheses?

Mechanism: plurality → disproportionality

- Consider two electoral systems
- Same district magnitude (DM): 3 seats per district
- All districts have the same distribution of preferences

Population Favors	Plurality	Proportional
Left 66%	3 seats Left	2 seats Left
Right 33%		1 seat Right

→ 33% of the population can't get represented in plurality.

Data show: plurality → disproportionality

	Average level of disproportionality	Number of countries
Plurality	13.4	11
PR	4.8	21

Note: Computed from Lijphart 2012, 150-51. The measure of disproportionality is explained in Lijphart.

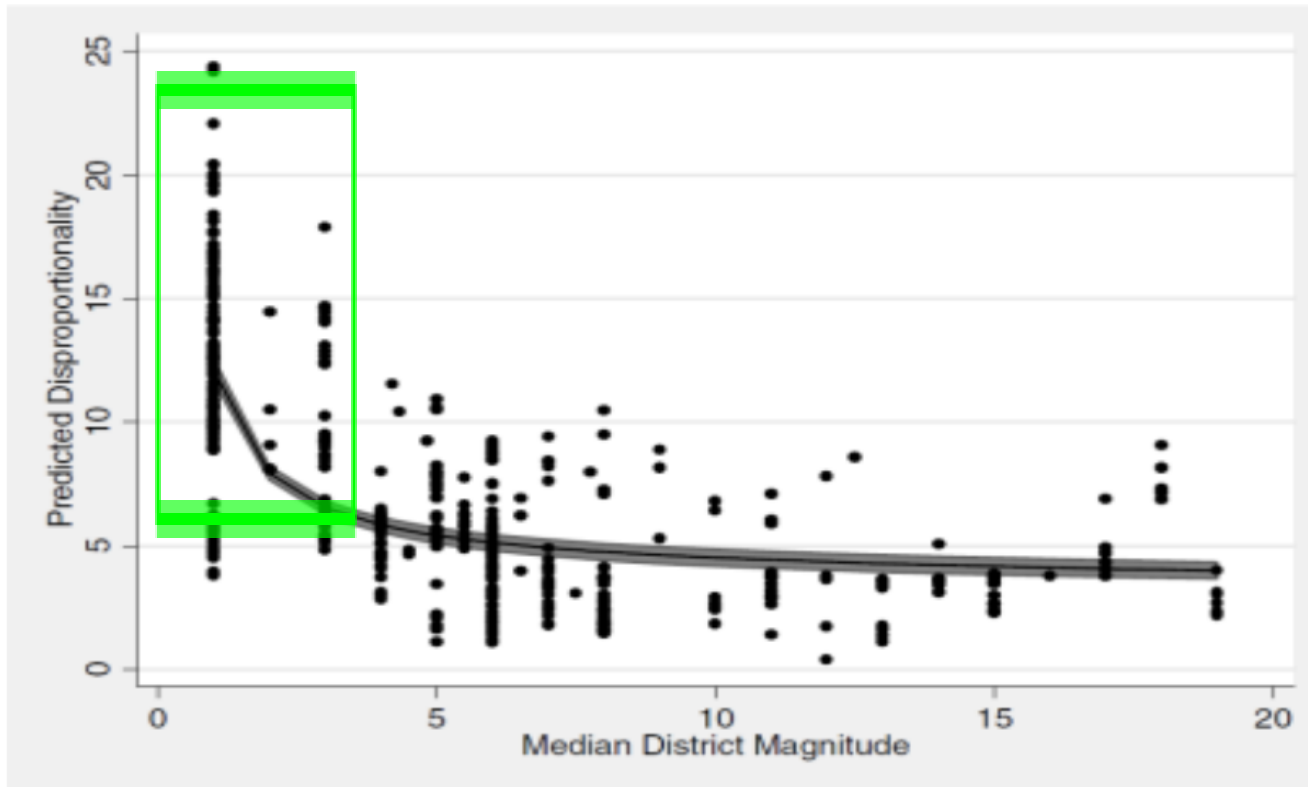
Mechanism: low DM $\rightarrow$ disproportionality in PR

- Consider two **PR** systems
- District magnitude of 3 in one and 10 in the other
- All districts have the same distribution of preferences

Population Favors	DM=3	DM=10
Left 62%	2 seats Left	6 seats Left
Right 30%	1 seat Right	3 seats Right
Green 7%	(likely)	1 seat Green

$\rightarrow$ 6% of the population not represented in DM=3.

Data show: low DM $\rightarrow$ disproportionality in PR



Source: Carey and Hix 2011

Mechanism: high DM → disproportionality in plurality?

- Consider two **plurality** systems
- District magnitude of 3 in one and 10 in the other
- All districts have the same distribution of preferences

Population Favors	DM=3	DM=10
Left 62%	3 seats Left	10 seats Left
Right 30%	(likely)	(likely)
Green 7%		

→ Same disproportionality!

R&D Senators: MT, WI, OH, WV

But: does high DM $\rightarrow$ disproportionality in plurality?

- Hard to know: nearly all plurality systems have $DM=1$.

What about the number of parties?

Duverger's hypothesis:

- Plurality electoral formulas favor a two-party system
- PR favors a multi-party system.

Why? What is the logic of these hypotheses?

Mechanisms of Duverger's Hypotheses

- Small parties will almost never win a plurality of votes in any district.
- Therefore: Voters will only vote for the top two parties to avoid wasting votes.
- And: Small parties won't enter, will drop out, or will form coalitions.

Data show: support for Duverger

(1) Plurality → 2 parties.

(2) PR → many more parties.

<i>Electoral system</i>	<i>Mean effective number of elective parties (Nv)</i>	<i>Mean effective number of parliamentary parties (Ns)</i>	<i>N</i>
Plurality/majority	2.78	2.20	22
All PR	4.55	3.90	50
Mixed compensatory	3.39	3.06	5
Mixed parallel	3.43	2.37	11

Source: Gallagher 2014